

Presentation Replication Paper Quants II + Extension

Personality Traits and Vote Switching: A Tale of Open-Minded Switchers and Agreeable Populism Resisters” by David Hamann and Sebastian Jäckle (2025)

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Introduction

- Which personality traits influence vote switching?
- Online Panel data from Germany, 3 waves, $N = 4351$
- Two interests:
 - General vote switching at least once across waves
 - Populism susceptibility: switching to AfD (Alternative für Deutschland) at least once
- Two logistic regression models M1 & M2; DV = Vote Switching Yes/No

- IVs: Big Five personality traits (OCEAN):
 - Openness: imaginative, curious, and open to new ideas and experiences
 - Conscientiousness: organized, disciplined, and goal-oriented
 - Extraversion: sociable, energetic, and seeks/enjoys company of others
 - Agreeableness: compassionate, cooperative, and trusting
 - Neuroticism: how prone to experiencing negative emotions such as anxiety, moodiness, and emotional instability

Hypotheses and Results: General Vote Switching

Hypotheses

- Openness ↑
- Conscientiousness ↓
- Extraversion ↓
- Agreeableness ↑
- Neuroticism: no clear expectation



Results

- Openness ↑ **
- Conscientiousness ↑ (!!) ***
- Extraversion: ↓ *
- Agreeableness: no effect
- Neuroticism: weak ↑ *

Note: * $p < 0.1$; ** $p < 0.05$; *** $p < 0.01$

Hypotheses and Results: AfD Vote Switching

Hypotheses

- Openness ↓
- Conscientiousness ↑
- Extraversion: no expectation
- Agreeableness ↓
- Neuroticism ↑



Results

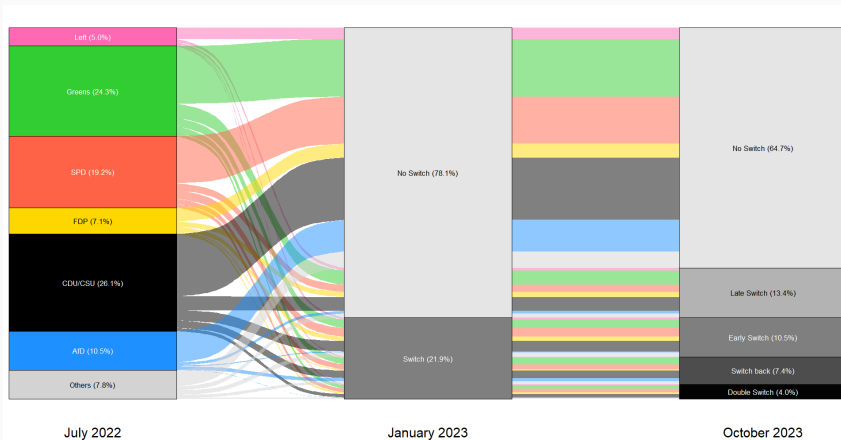
- Openness no effect
- Conscientiousness ↑ *
- Extraversion no effect
- Agreeableness no effect
- Neuroticism: no effect
- Left-right self-placement strongest predictor

Note: * $p < 0.1$; ** $p < 0.05$; *** $p < 0.01$

Replication

Replication Approach

- Reproduced:
 - Figures 2 to 6 → worked mostly well; minor visual differences only
 - Models M1 and M2 → exact same result, same direction and magnitude of effects



Extensions

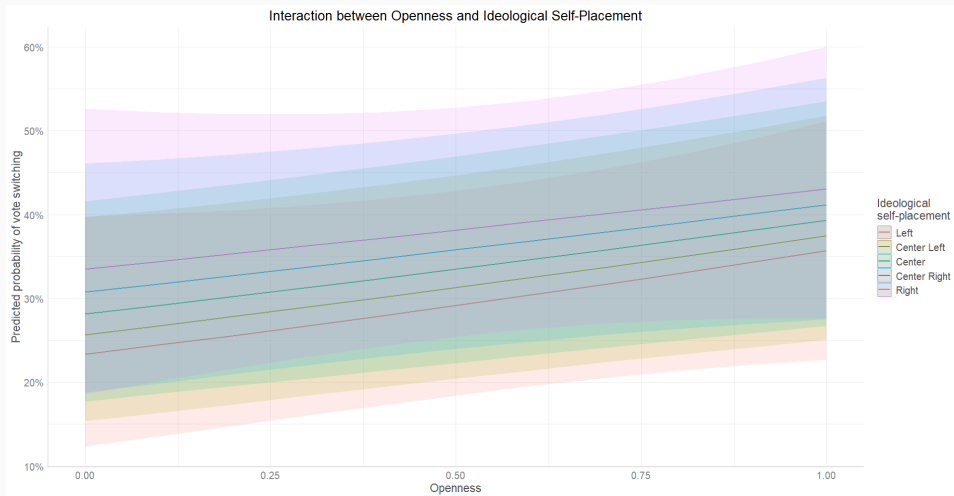
Extension 1: Diagnostics & Interaction Effect (M1)

- Model diagnostics: no multicollinearity ($VIF \approx 1$), logit linearity assumption holds
- Interaction Effect
 - Tested: Openness $\times$ ideology (left-right placement, 5-point scale)
 - Core idea: Party loyalty stronger on the right, should cover up effects of Openness
 - Low openness $\times$ right-wing: strong reliance on party loyalty and ideological consistency
 - High openness $\times$ right-wing: weaker reliance on ideological cues, stable due to stronger baseline loyalty
- Finding: Openness has a slightly weaker effect for right-leaning individuals. But: Result not significant

$$\beta = -0.19, \quad p = 0.80$$

- Openness has a uniform effect on vote switching across the political spectrum

Extensions: Diagnostics & Interaction Effect II (M1)



Extension2: Additional Variable & Model Selection (M2)

- Adding GAL-TAN variable (cultural ideology) from dataset:
 - GAL: Green-Alternative-Libertarian (pro-diversity, pro-immigration, progressive)
 - TAN: Traditional-Authoritarian-Nationalist (order, tradition, anti-immigration)
- Improves model fit (AIC: 1346 $\rightarrow$ 1330)
- Has a strong positive and significant effect ($\beta \approx 1.69$, $p < 0.01$)
 - More TAN-oriented individuals are substantially more likely to switch to the AfD
- Left-right ideology remains highly significant but decreases (7.25 $\rightarrow$ 5.98)
- Conscientiousness remains robust and significant across models
- Other personality traits remain insignificant
- Then: stepwise model selection from full model

Extension 2: Additional Variable & Model Selection (M2) II

Table 3: Logistic Regression Models for Susceptibility to Populism

	<i>Dependent variable: Susceptibility to populism</i>		
	M2	M2 + GAL-TAN	Selected Model
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Openness	0.315 (0.373)	0.465 (0.375)	
Conscientiousness	0.899* (0.471)	0.973** (0.472)	1.061** (0.442)
Extraversion	-0.007 (0.364)	-0.069 (0.367)	
Agreeableness	-0.151 (0.456)	-0.127 (0.456)	
Neuroticism	-0.111 (0.426)	-0.066 (0.426)	

Extension 2: Additional Variable & Model Selection (M2) III

Table 3: Logistic Regression Models for Susceptibility to Populism

	<i>Dependent variable: Susceptibility to populism</i>		
	M2 (1)	M2 + GAL-TAN (2)	Selected Model (3)
Left-right self-placement	7.250*** (0.536)	5.978*** (0.621)	5.924*** (0.610)
GAL-TAN		1.686*** (0.430)	1.674*** (0.427)
Age	0.001 (0.005)	-0.00001 (0.005)	
Gender (female)	-0.259 (0.160)	-0.283* (0.160)	-0.284* (0.156)
Region (West Germany)	-0.261 (0.200)	-0.199 (0.201)	
Constant	-5.431*** (0.844)	-5.915*** (0.860)	-5.933*** (0.661)
Observations	3,816	3,816	3,816
Log Likelihood	-656.041	-647.165	-648.355
Akaike Inf. Crit.	1,346.082	1,330.330	1,320.710

Note: * $p < 0.1$; ** $p < 0.05$; *** $p < 0.01$

Conclusion

- Replication overall successful ✓
- Personality matters for general switching, esp. Openness and Consciousness ✓
- Ideology dominates AfD switching, personality poor predictor ×
- Cultural ideology (GAL-TAN) adds explanatory power ✓
- Best model drops some variables that were used in og paper ✓

Thank you for your attention! :-)

Questions?

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